Linux Basic Commands

Day- 2

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File & Directory Navigation

ls	List files and directories.
[ls Options]	
ls -a	Shows all files, including hidden files (starting with .)
ls -l	Display files in a long listing format (shows permissions, owner, size, timestamp, etc.)
cd	Change directory.
cd ..	Move up 1 directory (to the parent dir)
cd ../..	2 directory step back
pwd	Show current working directory.
date	Show the current date & time.

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File Management

touch file_name	Create an empty file or to update the timestamp of existing file.
cp file1 file2	Copy a file.
mv file1 file2	Move or rename a file.
rm filename	Delete a file.
rm -r dirname	Delete a directory and its contents.

Directory Management

mkdir dirname	Create a new directory.
rm -rf dirname	Forcefully remove a directory and its contents.

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File Viewing & Editing

cat file_name View file contents.

more file_name Displays file content one page at a time. Only allows forward navigation.

less file_name View large files page by page. Allows both forward & backward navigation

[Text Editors]

nano file_name Simple & beginner friendly.
Exit: CTRL + X
Save: CTRL + O

vim file_name Advanced, fast, & efficient. Works in command & insert modes.

- Insert Mode: Press i
- Save & Exit: ESC + :wq!
- Quit Without Saving: ESC + :q!

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gedit filename It is a graphical text editor, used in documentation.

Relative Path

Relative path is the path to a file/folder starting from your current location.
It is shortcut based on your current location.

Example: cd Documents
(If you are in /home/user/, this command takes you to /home/user/Documents)

Absolute Path

Absolute path is the full path from the root of the file system (/) to a file or folder.

Example: cd /home/user/Documents
(This works from anywhere because it specifies the full path from / (root).)

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